

# Folk Dancing





## About the Course

Learn basic steps for individual, couple, and/or group dances using traditional folk songs.

This topic is included in the following course(s): PE: Grades 1-3, PE: Grades 4-6

**PE: Grades 1-3**

Lessons specifically created for Grades 1-6. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.

**PE: Grades 4-6**

Lessons specifically created for Grades 1-6. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.



## Scheduling

| GRADE | SCHEDULE INFO.                     | BOOKS                   |
|-------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1-6   | Folk Dancing<br>1 time/week 20 min | The Book of Song Dances |

### Sample Weekly View

| Day 1                 | Day 2               | Day 3                     | Day 4               | Day 5        |
|-----------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|---------------------|--------------|
| <b>PE: Grades 1-3</b> |                     |                           |                     |              |
| Jump Rope             | Free Play           | Playground Songs & Rhymes | Free Play           | Folk Dancing |
| <b>PE: Grades 4-6</b> |                     |                           |                     |              |
| Playground Games      | Free Play/ Circuits | Sports                    | Free Play/ Circuits | Folk Dancing |



## Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

**LINKS:** Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

**PE: Grades 1-3**

☐ Read the Introduction for Playground Songs & Rhymes p.5

☐ Bookmark the song playlist on SoundCloud. These include songs for folk dances, playground songs and rhymes, and jump rope. Create a free SoundCloud account to use offline. There are links to individual songs in lessons.

☐ Preview games and songs.

PE: Grades 4-6

☐ You may need to gather supplies for the activities, so plan accordingly.

Folk Dancing

☐ Read the Introduction for The Book of Song Dances p.4-9.

☐ Bookmark the video folder of folk dances.

☐ Preview dance video; learn beforehand to teach students.



## Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Folk Dancing



The Book of Song Dances



## Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)  
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



## Quick Links

Folk Dancing

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Video Folder of Folk Dances](#)

### Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [SoundCloud Song Playlist](#)

Click THIS text  
or scan the QR  
code for links.



# Folk Dancing

## How To Teach



### Overview

Mason emphasized that being physically fit is just as important as being mentally and spiritually fit. She used a combination of Swedish Drill (calisthenic exercises done to music or military-style commands), playground games, sports, dance, free play, and afternoon walks to make sure students had time for vigorous exercise every single day.



### Introduce

Teach students the new song, dance, or sport. Tutorials are often provided.



### Practice

Play your new game, practice your new dance, sing your new rhyme, etc.!



## Term 1

### WEEK 1 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 1

*Great Big House*

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Great Big House on p.30. Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

#### → INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Great Big House. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

#### → LISTEN

∞ Audio Link: Great Big House  
∞ Audio Link: Great Big House (piano only)

#### → VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.  
∞ Video Link: Great Big House

### WEEK 2 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 2

*Great Big House*

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

#### → RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.  
∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

#### → VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.  
∞ Video Link: Great Big House

### WEEK 3 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 3

*Great Big House*

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

#### → RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.  
∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

#### → LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.  
∞ Video Link: Great Big House